

The Bottle

The Lantern Coast - Low Tide - Chapter 1

The lamp had burned down to its last finger of oil by the time she finished reading, and still she did not move. Outside, the rain had turned the courtyard into a sheet of hammered tin, loud enough that she had not heard the messenger arrive, nor heard him leave.

Placeholder text. Replace this file with a real chapter of your novel - the site reads whatever PDFs it finds, so nothing here needs to change but the file itself.

She folded the letter along its old creases until it was small enough to disappear inside her palm, and then she sat with it there, the way one sits with a bird that has stopped struggling. There would be time to decide in the morning. There is always, she told herself, time to decide in the morning.

That was the first lie of many, and she would remember it later with something close to fondness - the last small untruth she told before the large ones became necessary.

Continued

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